

Outlook

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Can we distinguish a cyber event from a payments outage?

Hi,

This came up in a working session and nobody had the same definition.

Timeouts, host-response failures and repeated attempts can resemble malicious activity or ordinary service degradation.

I do not want a dashboard that simply counts the outcome. Start with the competing explanations: operational retries are obscuring the original event; a concentrated account or terminal pattern suggests abuse; or technical failure explains the cluster.

Several teams are reporting more failed or retried activity than they expected, but they do not agree on the cause. There are enough data exceptions to make a polished average dangerous; preserve the unresolved cases.

What we need to decide is the minimum evidence needed to route an alert to Cyber, Fraud, Payments or Infrastructure. Please bring a working Excel file with the exception population and clear columns, including a few cases we can trace from source to conclusion.

The available evidence is transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency. This is triage design from available telemetry, not a substitute for SOC, firewall or application logs.

Thank you